

OUTLINE

GOD SHAPES YOU BEFORE HE USES YOU

Scripture Passage: Genesis 37–50

Key Text: Genesis 50:20 – "You intended to harm me, but God intended it for good to accomplish what is now being done, the saving of many lives."

INTRODUCTION

In Genesis 37, we meet a 17-year-old young man named Joseph who also had big dreams given directly to him by God. But before Joseph could step into his calling, he had to go through a process. God did not just drop Joseph onto a throne; He shaped his heart first.

If we look closely at Genesis chapters 37 through 50, we discover three clear stages of how God prepares us for His purpose:

1. The Revelation of the Dream (Genesis 37:5–11)
2. The Refinement through the Trial (Genesis 39:1–23)
3. The Restoration by the Promise (Genesis 41:38–41; 50:20)

POINT 1: THE REVELATION OF THE DREAM

God reveals His purpose in His time.

In Genesis 37:5–11, God gave Joseph two prophetic dreams. In these dreams, sheaves of grain and stars bowed down to him, signifying that he would one day be a great leader.

Joseph was young and eager, but receiving a vision from God is only the starting point. God knew the beginning, middle, and end of Joseph's life. God did not reveal the dream to make Joseph feel superior to his brothers, but to reveal that He had a specific purpose for Joseph's life.

POINT 2: THE REFINEMENT THROUGH THE TRIAL

God builds our character in the dark moments.

In Genesis 39, Joseph's life took a drastic turn. Betrayed by his own brothers, sold as a slave into Egypt, and later falsely accused by Potiphar's wife, Joseph was thrown into a dungeon for years.

Notice what Genesis 39:2 and 39:21 emphasize: "The Lord was with Joseph." Even in slavery and in prison, Joseph did not grow bitter, cheat, or surrender to despair. Instead, he worked diligently, stayed honest, and served others. God used the furnace of affliction to burn

away pride and build humility, integrity, and faith. God cared more about who Joseph was becoming on the inside than how fast he got to the top.

POINT 3: THE RESTORATION BY THE PROMISE

God fulfils His word to accomplish His purpose.

In Genesis 41 and 50, after years of waiting and remaining faithful, Pharaoh elevated Joseph to governor of Egypt. Joseph stored food during seven years of abundance, ultimately saving nations—and his own family—from severe famine.

Thirteen years after receiving the dream, Joseph saw it fulfilled. But notice why God raised him up: not for self-glory, but to save lives. In Genesis 50:20, Joseph tells his brothers, "You intended to harm me, but God intended it for good." Had Joseph become ruler at age 17 without the lessons of the pit and the prison, he would lack the humility and wisdom required to handle such responsibility.

CONCLUSION

God gives the dream to show us His direction.

God builds our character to make us ready for the assignment.

God fulfils His promise to bring glory to His name.

As we prepare for our futures, let us submit to God's shaping hand today so that He can use us powerfully tomorrow.